

Unit »1

Human Actions and the Environment

» Objectives

- I can describe human actions that affect the environment.
- I can present myself: my interests, concerns, desires and talents.
- I can describe changes between the past and the present.

In Context » Environmental Concerns

1.  **Read »** Match the photos of environmental problems with expressions from the Word Bank.

Word Bank

soil pollution water pollution
illegal mining air pollution
deforestation

Eco life

Subscribe to our newsletter

I'm concerned about ...



2.  **Speak »**

- Complete the human actions with expressions from the Word Bank.
- Discuss your environmental concerns with a partner. What human actions in exercise 2 are associated with the environmental problems in exercise 1?

Word Bank

dump waste
produce fumes
extract metals and minerals
cut down trees
use pesticides



I'm concerned about deforestation.

I am, too. People **cut down** too many trees.

1 3. Listen »

Read and listen to three stories about teenagers getting involved in their communities. Complete the text with environmental concerns from exercise 1.



I'm Carlos. I live in N3vita, Choc3. It's near the River T3mana. My friends and I love living in the rainforest with all its plants and animals. We're concerned about illegal _____. This activity pollutes rivers and streams, erodes land, and affects our health.

I'm Diego from Ciénaga. I'm the son of a fisherman and I live near the lagoon. I'm worried about fish. They are dying because the level of oxygen is low. There is too much water ____.

I'm Luisa. I live in Arcabuco, Boyac3. I enjoy walking in these beautiful mountains. I'm concerned about _____. A lot of people cut down trees for agriculture and cattle farming. It affects ecosystems and biodiversity.

2 4. Listen »

Label the photos with the expressions in the box. Then listen and match the photos with the conversations.

organize and sign a petition

go on a demonstration

create an environmental newsletter

volunteer to plant trees



a. _____ b. _____ c. _____ d. _____

5. **Speak** » Work with a partner. Discuss the things you **would like to do** and the things you **would not like to do**.

- rescue abandoned animals
- pick up rubbish in a public place
- organize a petition
- participate in a demonstration
- volunteer at a community garden
- design a website.

I **would like to** rescue abandoned animals.

I **wouldn't like to** pick up rubbish, but I **would like to** organize a petition.

6. **Speak** » Look at the pictures and find four differences.



Before, the air **was** polluted, but **now** the air **is** pure.

Now there **are** a lot of trees. **Before**, there **were** no trees.

7. **Read** » Complete the text with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

A Story of Change

La Paz School is a rural school in the mountains of Central Colombia. A few years ago, teachers and students ^a_____ (decide) to do something about the environmental problems they had. Deforestation and bad management of waste ^b_____ (be) their main concerns. As a result, they ^c_____ (create) an environmental group to look for solutions.

First, they ^d_____ (research) information about the people, their businesses and the impact of their actions. Then, they ^e_____ (organize) a campaign to protect the rivers in their town. They ^f_____ (talk) to the local authorities about prohibiting the industries from

dumping waste. They ^g_____ (start) teaching people about recycling methods and the whole town ^h_____ (sign) a petition to stop the destruction of their forests. They ⁱ_____ (plant) more than 2,000 trees near the river.

Now people in our town ^j_____ (be) happy with the results. Liliana, a 15-year-old student at La Paz School, said: 'Now we ^k_____ (have) lots of trees around our houses and parks; the rivers are clean; and we understand that when people work together to support a cause, the little things that everyone ^l_____ (do) can create big changes.'

8. **Write** » In groups, create a mind map to show how some human actions affect the environment negatively in your community or school. Then choose one problem to investigate and write notes about.

Study Tip

Create a diagram to show the relationship between ideas.

Expanding Knowledge » Working for a Cause!

1. Read »

Three friends are creating an online eco-newsletter. Complete the profiles with the correct form of the verb in brackets. Then match each profile with an occupation.

Juana is good at ^a _____ (read and write). She enjoys ^b _____ (talk) to people. She's interested in ^c _____ (protect) the rivers and lagoons in her area. She would like ^d _____ (do) research into the levels of pollution.



1. Designer or photographer

Mateo loves ^e _____ (take) photos. He also likes ^f _____ (design and draw) pictures of animals and flowers. He's good at ^g _____ (use) software and applications. He would like ^h _____ (travel) to remote villages to learn about other people.



2. Editor/ writer

Carlos enjoys ⁱ _____ (read) books. He's very good at ^j _____ (spell) words and ^k _____ (correct) mistakes. He has written some articles for the school newspaper and has helped many classmates with their essays. He would like ^l _____ (work) with indigenous communities.



3. Journalist

2. Pronunciation»

3

a. Notice the different pronunciations of -ed. Listen and repeat.

I'm concerned about deforestation.
/d/

I'm interested in planting trees in the school yard.
/əd/

b. In natural speech, final consonants are linked to the next vowel sound. Listen and repeat.

I'm concerned about illegal mining.
/aimkənsərn**d**əbaw**t**il:ɡəlmajniŋ/

I'm interested in planting trees in the school.
/aimintrəstəd**ən**plæntiŋtri:z**ən**ðəskul/